



PROJECT OVERVIEW AND PLAN

1. Project Information

Project Title:	UUFANJ AOC Database Redesign Project
MBS Advisor(s):	
Organization Mentor(s) :	
Student Team Lead:	
Industry/Technical Focus:	Social action, Database management, Data analytics
Dates (Begin/End):	6/2/2026 - 8/11/2026
Company Mentor Meeting Day/Time: <i>(Day of week and time for usual meeting)</i>	Tuesdays from 11:00 AM to 12:00 PM
Student Team Internal Working Meeting Day/Time: <i>(Day of week and time for usual meeting when just the students meet for a working meeting outside of the meeting with your Advisor/Mentor)</i>	Fridays from 3:15 PM to 4:30 PM

2. Project Student Team

Name	E-Mail	Telephone	Notes: (Availability, etc.)
James			Available all day Monday through Friday, except from 10-11 Mondays and 1-3 on Wednesdays
Oma			Available all days, except Friday 12-2
Reuben Thomas			Available Monday through Friday



2. Project Student Team

Name	E-Mail	Telephone	Notes: (Availability, etc.)
Ayaan 			Available Monday through Friday except 12pm-4pm on Fridays

3. Individual Roles /Responsibilities (high level overview)

Name: Role

James  In addition to serving as team lead, James will be responsible for conducting relevant research on the project, including outreach to relevant third parties. Additionally, he will be responsible for assisting Reuben with any database or coding tasks he is not covering, including providing his own version of a procedure for cleaning input data to share with the group.

Reuben Thomas: Reuben will be leading the database effort for the project. He will be responsible for making sure that the database-related objectives of the project are met, particularly the database design and the process of moving the data from Excel to SQL.

Oma 

Ayaan  Ayaan is responsible for helping out with database efforts as well as addressing any non-technical matters within the project. Particularly, Ayaan will work on the python execution program for cleaning the dataset and it will be used against the stored procedure to compare which of the two works best with the dataset.

4. Communication Strategy

(Team will develop overall business communication strategy and share with MBS Advisor and Company Mentor. How, When, Frequency?)

Important notes: The entire team needs to agree on the communication channels and document sharing tools. *Once agreed upon, Team lead should send out meeting invitation

***Meeting Tools/Platforms:** (e.g. Google Hangouts, Zoom, WebEx, etc)

We will be using Zoom for both internal meetings and meetings with mentors due to externs' familiarity with the platform, as Zoom is used for other classwork.

Document Sharing Tools: (e.g. Microsoft Teams, Google Docs, Box, Dropbox, etc.)

The Google suite of productivity apps, including Google Drive, Google Docs, Google Slides, Google Sheets, etc., will be used for document sharing because it's the same platform that the mentors use to share documents with externs, and it is easier to share and set up simultaneous collaboration amongst team members versus the Microsoft Office suite of apps.

Daily – How will you communicate questions or issues? (email, whatsapp, text messages, etc.?)



4. Communication Strategy

(Team will develop overall business communication strategy and share with MBS Advisor and Company Mentor. **How, When, Frequency?**)

Internally, amongst team members, messages including questions, comments, and concerns about the project will be sent in a GroupMe created for the project. For quick messages and questions with project mentors, WhatsApp will be used. For any formal correspondence, including sharing questions and concerns with the project advisors and emails to third parties for information, email will be used. Messages and questions will be sent via GroupMe and WhatsApp as needed.

Weekly/ Bi-weekly Status Report – How will you communicate the current project status? (email, whatsapp, text messages, etc.?)

Current project status will be shared with mentors and advisors via email weekly when the team lead submits the meeting agenda and weekly update slides to the project mentors.

5. Project Scope

a. Project Deliverables:

The project focuses on redesigning and reconstructing the New Jersey Office of the Attorney General's Use of Force and Arrive Together public databases to improve data quality, accessibility, and analytical capabilities. The project aims to merge and normalize two databases, the New Jersey "Use of Force" and "ArriveTogether", to better identify patterns in law enforcement encounters, particularly those involving mental health crises. Using different platforms like MySQL and Python, the team will analyze existing data architectures and design a modified structure to resolve data entry inconsistencies, and implement an automated process for importing regular updates. Overall, the final goal is to create more queryable data to support policy recommendations aimed at reducing incidents of injury or death.

b. Company/Organization Background Research:

Important note: Please find/use additional resources outside of the information given when receiving your project assignment.

UUFANJ is the Unitarian Universalist Faith Action New Jersey. Unitarian Universalist FaithAction New Jersey (UUFANJ) is a statewide organization focused on advancing social justice, human rights, and community advocacy across New Jersey. The organization works with faith communities, community members, and partner organizations to address issues including racial justice, immigration, environmental justice, and criminal justice reform. They coordinate social justice advocacy with our member congregations and individual UUs and allies across the state of New Jersey. They work to establish a just and compassionate public policy, guided by our Unitarian Universalist values and covenant: upholding the worth and dignity of every person, furthering justice, equity, and compassion in human relations, defending the use of inclusive democratic processes, protecting religious freedom, and promoting respect for the interdependent web of all existence.



Unitarian Universalist FaithAction NJ

c. Kickoff Questions for Mentor(s): (Everyone)

Reuben Thomas -

James [REDACTED] - We noticed that one of the first assignments in the project syllabus is to reach out to our local police departments regarding mental health call responses. Who would be the best person at the department to ask about this, and what would be the best way to reach them?

Ayaan [REDACTED] Are there specific design elements within the database that the team needs to follow in regards to the data? or example, are there different date formats that need to be followed with the database?

Oma [REDACTED]

d. Early Background Research for Kickoff or 2nd Meeting:

UUFANJ stands for Unitarian Universalist Faith Action New Jersey. UUFANJ is a statewide organization focused on advancing social justice, human rights, and community advocacy across New Jersey. The two databases given to the team to use were the Use of Force and Arrive Together databases. The preliminary research resulted in reaching out to the team members of different counties local police departments and to contact them on the use of the two respective databases. Additionally, the team was given questions by the mentors to answer regarding the two databases as well as familiarizing themselves with the New Jersey Criminal Justice System.

e. Project Management:

How are you tracking the timeline of your project and your team's progress? How are you keeping track of your project's metrics? (i.e. RASCI Document, Gantt Charts, KPI's, Dashboards, Weekly Meetings, etc.)

Each week, the project mentors assign tasks to the group. After each meeting with the mentors, the group has an internal meeting to discuss takeaways and divide up the work. We check the progress of team members during Friday's internal meeting. Ultimately, work should be done by the end of Sunday so that the team has time to review and submit deliverables and weekly update slides to the mentors by the end of the day Monday. Feedback is provided by mentors for each assignment during each meeting.

f. Project Timeline:

Provide the anticipated timeline for your project progress including 2 or more specific metrics for stages or completion of your project. Dates can be estimated. (i.e. RASCI Document, Gantt Charts, KPI's, Dashboards, Weekly Meetings, etc.)

Timeline for the project based on the syllabus provided by Mentors at the start of the project. By June 23, 2026, several tables, a stored procedure, and an external program need to be created to clean data as it is imported into the database. By June 30, 2026, the initial redesigned database must be tested with queries to identify any issues. All database model testing must be completed by July 28, 2026. On August 4, 2026, mentors will sign off on the final project so that the externs can prepare their findings and project for presentation during the Lightning Talk and Handoff Presentation. Further tasks and metrics are provided by mentors during weekly meetings as needed.



6. Project Description (1 formal paragraph detailing what your project is, your goals, written in essay format, approx. 200-300 words minimum. If you have multiple sub-teams, each sub-team should write their own)

a. Project Description – Extended Version: (In Your Words)

Start with the why. Why is the project needed? Additionally, what is the purpose or overall goal or problem the group is working towards? What is the final deliverable(s) or project objectives?

The New Jersey Use of Force Database is a valuable public resource that contains thousands of reported law enforcement use-of-force incidents across the state. The database has the potential to reveal important patterns regarding police interactions with the public, use-of-force practices, demographic trends, and responses to individuals experiencing mental health crises. However, the current database is distributed as a large Excel spreadsheet with several design limitations that make complex analysis and querying difficult. Improving the structure of this data can make it more accessible to researchers, policymakers, advocacy organizations, and members of the public seeking to better understand law enforcement practices and accountability. The goal of this project is to redesign the New Jersey Use of Force Database into a more efficient, query-friendly relational database while preserving the integrity of the original data. Working with mentors from UUFANJ, our team will examine the existing database structure, identify design issues, and develop a new database architecture that supports more effective analytical querying. Particular attention will be given to challenges such as multi-value fields, inconsistent data representations, and data standardization. In addition to the technical database redesign, our team will conduct research on use-of-force policies and the ARRIVE Together program to better understand how mental health crises are handled by law enforcement agencies throughout New Jersey. The final deliverables for this project will include a redesigned database schema, a cleaned and optimized database hosted online, documentation describing the redesign process and data-cleaning methodology, and a research summary informed by public resources as well as conversations with local and state government officials. Together, these deliverables will support more meaningful analysis of use-of-force data and contribute to a greater understanding of public safety practices in New Jersey.

b. Problem Statement:

1 or 2 Sentence short version.

The New Jersey Use of Force dataset has the potential to provide important insights into policing practices, use-of-force trends, and responses to mental health-related incidents. However, inconsistencies in the data and limitations in the current database design make the dataset difficult to query and analyze, reducing its accessibility and usefulness for researchers, policymakers, and community members seeking to better understand law enforcement activities.

7. NDA Acknowledgement (Indicate if your team is required to sign an NDA and have your team lead sign off. IF your team requires an NDA, you **MUST** upload each signed document to this assignment to receive full credit.)



Unitarian Universalist FaithAction NJ



Does your company or organization require an NDA? (YES/NO): No

Team Lead sign off (you may use e-signing software or include a photo of a signature):

